

mail of the week

suit their convenience. He is a manipulator par excellence. This time again, he has proved his prowess as a power-broker by garnering the required numbers to save the Manmohan Singh Government. COL. (RETD) C.V. VENUGOPALAN, *on e-mail*

Left Alone

The Left leaders clinging to their fossilised ideologies never realised that, sooner or later, the rug from under their feet would be pulled ("Red Alert", July 28). The Government not only won the confidence vote but also shed off extra flab, the Left, very conveniently. Now, after being shown the door, the Left should realise that it has bitten more than it can chew. Prakash Karat and his ilk in the Politburo should resign, making way for a wiser and more pragmatic team to take over the reigns of the CPI(M). Quixotic obsessions of Karat will lead the party to slow disintegration. K.M.G. VIVEKANANDAM, *Madurai*

In this era of globalisation and fast changing geo-economic and geo-political scenario, Left parties in India are truly anachronistic. While their peers in Russia, China and elsewhere have adopted progressive, pragmatic and astonishingly successful policies, Left parties here are blinded by their anti-American dharma. They remain impervious to immediate and long-term national interests, ignoring them to serve

their own political gains. SURENDER MAKHIJA, *Delhi*

Faith Lives On

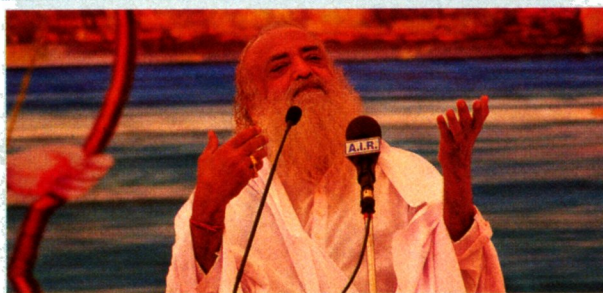
The success stories of the visually challenged showed sheer grit, tenacity of purpose and firm resolution of these lesser mortals ("Blind Faith", July 28). People like K. Ramkrishna and Rajesh Mehta have proved that nothing can deter the spirit of a man who aims for nothing but the fish's eye, overcoming the odds and

fulfilling his cherished dreams, at last. SHEKHAR, *Bhagalpur*

Combating Fear

Ordinary people living in the Capital are insecure despite a 60,000-strong police force, while the VIPs enjoy the best security cover ("Fear Capital", July 28). Is security only for the VIPs? If ordinary people in the Capital are insecure, what about people in the interior parts of India? RAJA V.M., *on e-mail*

TROUBLED PARADISE



SHAKESH RAVAL

Asaram Bapu is the living example of a true Hindu saint who has single-handedly transformed many lives ("Clouded in Controversy", August 4). The ashram runs mobile hospitals, distributes ration cards for food in areas where even the government cannot reach and does relief work during natural disasters. It strives to uplift the poor, and protect and revive our heritage. He envisions an India that can be prosperous and become a spiritual leader if it follows the ancient wisdom given in the Gita. The ashram stands for peace and welfare of mankind. I am ashamed that INDIA TODAY questions the prosperity of the ashram. I have never seen the Western Press talk about the Pope's funds or why the Vatican is so prosperous.

SANJAY SINGH, *on e-mail*

Self-proclaimed enlightened masters like Asaram Bapu have opened spiritual shops and are cheating people in the name of God.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, *on e-mail*

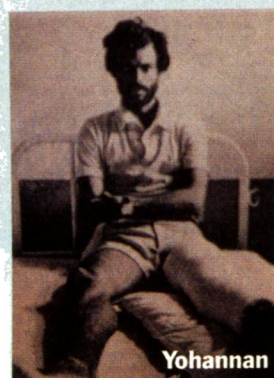
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Years Ago in India Today

SEPTEMBER 1-15, 1978



India Also Ran

With sports officials, coaches and managers busy playing their own



games, athletes often suffer through negligence—sometimes with tragic consequences. T.C. Yohannan is the most recent example of this. The long jumper's accident during a training session highlights glaring defects in at least three aspects of Indian sport. First, poor training facilities. If the landing pit at the NIS was so unsuitable for jumping, the state of training at facilities at smaller sports centres can be imagined. Second, the lack of prompt medical attention. Yohannan lay in the general ward of Patiala's Rajendra Hospital for three days before being transported to Delhi for an operation of his dislocated left knee. The delay in the operation almost cost him his athletic career. And third, officialdom's lack of concern.

—Minhaz Merchant

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